FROM TAMSUI TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Cypher/OTP

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Her Majesty's Consul
No.42
20th March, 1952.

D.5.4 p.m. 20th March, 1952.
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FJ 10310/64

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Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No.42 of 20th March
Repeated for information to Tokyo
and Saving to:- Hong Kong
Singapore

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My telegram No.33 and despatch No.547/31/52 of March 11th 1952 to Foreign Office.

Following is believed to be a reliable summary of present position in Japanese/Nationalist Chinese bilateral treaty negotiations.

2. After stubborn initial clashes a better atmosphere now prevails and substantial agreement has been reached on most points of difference, the Japanese on the whole having given more ground than the Chinese. Final Chinese draft which is believed to have been reduced from 22 to 18 articles, was presented on March 18th.

3. This draft is generally on lines of the San Francisco Treaty. Sovereignty over continental China is implied and specific reference to return of Formosa and Piscadores to "China" is omitted. The only important outstanding issue is reparations, neither side showing any signs of giving way on this subject. A solution is being sought by finding an acceptable phraseology or by omitting all reference to reparations in the main treaty and dealing with the problem in an annexure or subsequent agreement.

4. Text of Chinese first draft published in Tokyo press on March 8th appears not to have been the genuine one. Although similar in many respects to the true draft, the preamble was entirely different and one important article had been omitted.

5. It is likely that a formula will be found to solve the reparation problem. I therefore consider that agreement

/will shortly be

21 MAR 1952

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will shortly be reached and that signature will take place within the next two or three weeks.

Foreign Office please pass to Tokyo as my telegram No.4.

[Repeated to Tokyo].

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China and Korea Department
Japan and Pacific Department

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